

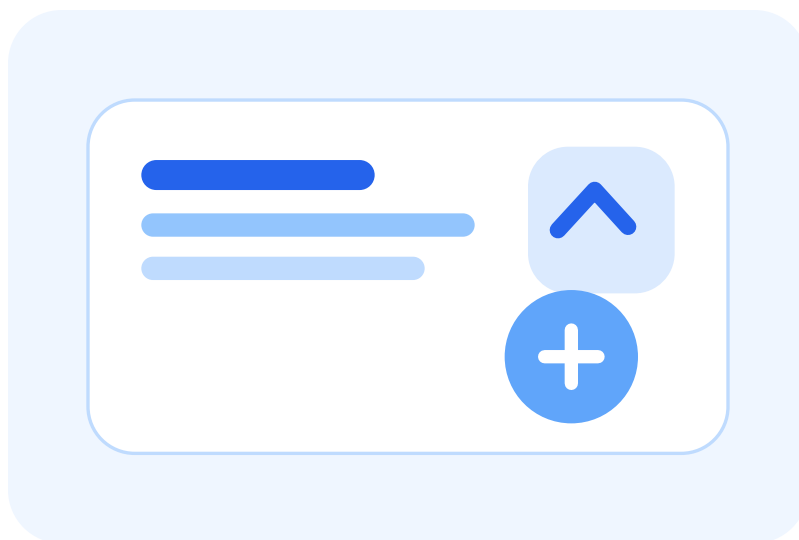
Preferences

Learn how to express preferences in English with clear grammar patterns, examples, and practice.

[Simple patterns](#)

[Real-life examples](#)

[Interactive practice](#)



SECTION 1 What is Preference?



A preference is the choice we like more than another option. We use it to show our first choice in daily life.

 **Remember:** Preference is about choosing one thing over another.

Definition

When we prefer something, we show that it is more attractive, useful, or enjoyable for us.

Pattern: I prefer X.

- I prefer music to noise.
- She prefers winter to summer.
- We prefer healthy food.

Tip: Preference is often used when we compare two choices.

Real-life examples

We use preferences all the time when choosing food, hobbies, study methods, or travel plans.

- I prefer to study in the morning.
- My brother prefers football to basketball.
- They prefer online lessons.

SECTION 2 Prefer + Noun



We use prefer + noun when we talk about choosing one thing over another.



Grammar Rule: Use prefer with a noun or noun phrase.

Basic structure

I prefer tea. / She prefers coffee.

- I prefer tea.
- She prefers coffee.
- They prefer honesty.

Tip: After prefer, you can use a noun such as tea, coffee, music, or freedom.

English examples with translation

- I prefer apples. — Elma tercih ederim.
- He prefers blue. — Maviyi tercih eder.
- We prefer quiet places. — Sessiz yerleri tercih ederiz.

SECTION 3 Prefer A to B



We use prefer A to B to say that we like A more than B.

★**Tip:** Prefer A to B is very common in comparisons.

Structure

Subject + prefer + A + to + B

- I prefer tea to coffee.
- She prefers reading to watching TV.
- We prefer city life to village life.

More examples

- He prefers summer to winter. — Yazı kışa tercih eder.
- They prefer books to games. — Oyunlardan çok kitapları tercih ederler.
- I prefer action movies to comedies. — Komedilerden çok aksiyon filmlerini tercih ederim.

SECTION 4 Prefer Verb-ing to Verb-ing



This pattern compares two activities. We use the -ing form after prefer.

Comparison table

Pattern	Meaning	Example
Prefer + verb-ing + to + verb-ing	Choose one activity over another	I prefer walking to driving.
Prefer + noun + to + noun	Choose one thing over another	I prefer tea to coffee.

Examples

- I prefer swimming to running.
- She prefers cooking to cleaning.
- We prefer listening to speaking.

SECTION 5 Prefer to + Verb



Use prefer to do when you want to talk about a specific action you choose.



Grammar Rule: Prefer to + base verb is used for decisions and habits.

Usage

- I prefer to walk home.
- She prefers to study at night.
- They prefer to stay indoors.

Tip: This pattern is common for personal choices and routines.

Difference

Prefer to do is more about a choice of action, while prefer + noun focuses on the thing itself.

SECTION 6 **Would Prefer**



Would prefer is more polite and often shows a specific preference in a situation.

Use

Would prefer + noun / would prefer to + verb

- I would prefer a quieter room.
- She would prefer to leave now.
- They would prefer coffee instead of tea.

Difference from prefer

Prefer is more general, while would prefer often sounds more polite or context-based.

SECTION 7 Would Rather

Would rather is used when we want to say one thing is more desirable than another.

Form	Meaning	Example
Prefer	General preference	I prefer tea.
Would prefer	More polite or specific preference	I would prefer tea.
Would rather	Immediate or clearer preference	I would rather drink tea.

SECTION 8 Favorite

Favorite shows the thing you like most. Prefer shows a choice between options.

💡 **Difference:** Favorite means the best-liked one; prefer means to choose one over another.

Favorite

- My favorite color is blue.
- Her favorite food is pizza.
- English is my favorite subject.

Prefer

- I prefer blue to red.
- She prefers pizza to pasta.
- We prefer English to math.

SECTION 9 Common Mistakes



✗ I prefer tea than coffee.

✓ I prefer tea to coffee.

✗ She prefer tea.

✓ She prefers tea.

✗ I would rather to go.

✓ I would rather go.

✗ My favorite food is pizza than pasta.

✓ My favorite food is pizza.

✗ I prefer to studying.

✓ I prefer to study.

✗ He would prefer staying home.

✓ He would prefer to stay home.

 I prefer swim.

 I prefer swimming.

 She would rather to eat.

 She would rather eat.

 We prefer eat healthy food.

 We prefer to eat healthy food.

 I prefer tea over coffee.

 I prefer tea to coffee.

SECTION 10 Practice

Complete the exercises below to reinforce what you learned.

1. Complete: I ___ tea to coffee.

Check

2. Complete: She ___ swimming to running.

Check

3. Complete: We would ___ to stay home.

Check

4. Complete: My ___ color is blue.

Check

5. Complete: I would ___ a quieter room.

Check

6. Put in order: prefer / I / tea / to / coffee

Check

7. Put in order: rather / would / stay / I / home

Check

8. Put in order: favorite / my / subject / is / English

Check

9. True or false: 'I prefer tea than coffee' is correct.

Choose



Check

10. True or false: 'She prefers reading to watching TV' is correct.

Choose



Check

11. True or false: 'I would rather go' is correct.

Choose



Check

12. True or false: 'He prefer coffee' is correct.

Choose



Check

13. Drag the words to make the correct sentence.

I prefer swimming to running

Check

14. Complete: They ___ to study at night.

Check

15. Complete: We ___ books to games.

Check

SECTION 11 Quiz

Answer these 20 multiple-choice questions to test yourself.

1. I ___ tea to coffee.

☐ prefer

☐ prefers

☐ preferring

☐ preferred

2. She ___ coffee every morning.

☐ prefer

☐ prefers

☐ preferring

☐ to prefer

3. Which sentence is correct?

☐ I prefer tea than coffee.

☐ I prefer tea to coffee.

☐ I prefer tea over coffee.

☐ I prefer tea for coffee.

4. We use 'prefer A to B' when we want to ____.

- ☐ compare two choices
- ☐ describe a place
- ☐ talk about the past
- ☐ ask a question

5. Choose the correct form: 'He ___ swimming to running.'

- ☐ prefer
- ☐ prefers
- ☐ preferring
- ☐ preferred

6. Which sentence means a polite preference?

- ☐ I prefer tea.
- ☐ I would prefer tea.
- ☐ I prefer to tea.
- ☐ I favorite tea.

7. Would rather is used when you want to show a _____ preference.

- ☐ general
- ☐ stronger or more immediate
- ☐ future
- ☐ negative

8. My favorite color is _____.

- ☐ blue
- ☐ prefer
- ☐ rather
- ☐ would

9. Which one is correct?

- ☐ I prefer to study.
- ☐ I prefer studying.
- ☐ Both are possible.
- ☐ Neither is correct.

10. Choose the correct sentence.

- ☐ She would rather stay home.
- ☐ She would rather to stay home.
- ☐ She would rather staying home.
- ☐ She would rather home.

11. We say 'I prefer to walk' when we talk about ____.

- ☐ a noun
- ☐ an action
- ☐ a place
- ☐ a person

12. Which is the best sentence?

- ☐ I prefer reading to watch TV.
- ☐ I prefer reading to watching TV.
- ☐ I prefer reading over watch TV.
- ☐ I prefer read to watching TV.

13. Favorite means ____.

- ☐ the most liked
- ☐ the least liked
- ☐ a future plan
- ☐ a negative preference

14. Which one is correct?

- ☐ I prefer tea than coffee.
- ☐ I prefer tea to coffee.
- ☐ I prefer tea from coffee.
- ☐ I prefer tea with coffee.

15. Choose the correct form: 'We ___ books to games.'

- ☐ prefer
- ☐ prefers
- ☐ preferring
- ☐ preferred

16. Would prefer often sounds more ____.

☐ casual

☐ polite

☐ angry

☐ formal

17. Which sentence uses favorite correctly?

☐ My favorite subject is English.

☐ My favorite subject are English.

☐ My favorite subject be English.

☐ My favorite subject prefer English.

18. I would rather ____ home tonight.

☐ stay

☐ staying

☐ to stay

☐ stayed

19. We use prefer + noun when we talk about ____.

☐ a thing

☐ a place

☐ a reason

☐ a time

20. Which is the best example of a comparison?

☐ I prefer tea.

☐ I prefer tea to coffee.

☐ My favorite food is pizza.

☐ I would rather go.

SECTION 12 **Summary**

Key points

- Prefer shows a choice between options.
- Prefer A to B compares two things clearly.
- Prefer to do is used for actions.
- Would prefer and would rather are more polite or more immediate.
- Favorite describes your top choice.

Mini reminder

I prefer tea to coffee. I would rather stay home.

My favorite subject is English.

Preferences Grammar Guide

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